

Poetry Writing Structure

How to build a beautiful poem

1.



1. Title

Choose a title that gives a clue about your poem.

What is your poem about?

2.



2. Theme / Idea

Decide on the main idea, feeling, or message of your poem.

What do you want to say?

3.



3. Poetic Devices

Add imagery, similes, metaphors, rhyme, or repetition to make your poem interesting.

Which poetic tools will you use?

4.



4. Lines & Stanzas

Organise your poem into lines and stanzas so it is easy to read and sounds right.

How will you arrange your poem?

5.



5. Edit & Share

Read your poem aloud, improve your word choices, and check that it sounds the way you want.

Does your poem sound just right?

Poetry Writing Tips



Use strong describing words



Create pictures in the reader's mind



Play with rhythm and sound



Try rhyme or repetition



Show feelings and ideas



Read it aloud to check the flow

THE ART OF WRITING POETRY: ELEMENTS, FORMS & TECHNIQUES

FUNDAMENTAL ELEMENTS

RHYME & METER



Patterned sounds & rhythm.
Rhyme schemes (AABB, ABAB).
Meter (Iambic, Trochaic)
creates the heartbeat.

LINEATION & STANZA



Visual structure.
Line breaks dictate pause
& emphasis.
Stanzas organize ideas
like paragraphs.

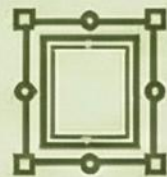
THEME & TONE



Core message & emotional
atmosphere.
Drives the poem's purpose
and speaker's perspective.

POETIC FORMS

FIXED VERSE



STRICT RULES

Sonnet (14 lines, specific rhyme),
Villanelle (19 lines, repeating refrains),
Haiku (3 lines, 5-7-5 syllables).

BLANK VERSE



UNRHYMED METER

Typically iambic pentameter.
Mimics natural speech with a
steady rhythm (e.g., Shakespeare).

FREE VERSE



NO SET RULES

Open form. Rhythm, rhyme,
and line length depend on the
poet's creative choice.

NARRATIVE & LYRIC



STORY VS. EMOTION

Narrative tells a tale with plot.
Lyric expresses personal
feelings and reflections.

TECHNIQUES & DEVICES



SOUND DEVICES

ALLITERATION (beginning sounds)
ASSONANCE (vowel sounds)
CONSONANCE (end
consonant sounds)
ONOMATOPOEIA
(sound words)



FIGURATIVE LANGUAGE

METAPHOR (direct comparison)
SIMILE (using "like" or "as")
PERSONIFICATION (human
qualities to non-human)



IMAGERY

VIVID DESCRIPTION
Appeals to sight, sound,
smell, taste, and touch
to create sensory
experiences.



RHETORICAL DEVICES

REPETITION (for emphasis)
ANAPHORA (repeating
sentence starts)
RHETORICAL QUESTIONS
(provoking thought)



STRUCTURE & SYNTAX

ENJAMBMENT (running lines
without pause)
CAESURA (mid-line pause)
JUXTAPOSITION
(contrasting ideas)

POETRY: WHERE WORDS DANCE AND EMOTIONS SING